

for colour and there are a variety of transition and style effects, then you need something more professional.

Video editing software are used for their multitude of reasons beyond just cutting clips and layering audio. The most important aspect of a good video editing suite is its workflow management. This means how well the software operates in taking your raw materials i.e. images, video clips, audio files etc. and organising them to make editing a smoother process. This is critical when dealing with lengthy projects that have a lot of varied elements such as a feature length film or a documentary. In both of these cases a typical project can have hundreds, if not thousands, of video clips along with scores of images and audio clips. An effective editing suite allows you to manage, organise and access these elements with ease and precision. In addition to this fundamental feature, the user interface is the next most important aspect of the tool.

Professional video editors allow for a wide range of editing techniques that you can imagine such as overlapping dialogue from different video clips, syncing audio recorded separately, editing light and colour in the video and so much more. It is these editing effects that separate armature videos from professional ones. The degree of complexity you wish to engage is dependent on the video you are seeking to make. So while free open source software may be sufficient for basic to intermediate video making there is a limit to which they can be practically useful under a professional setup. The limits of your editing software can have a great impact on how you shoot your video, for example: a professional video editing software can reduce or remove any hand-held camera problems like jitters with little problem but if your choice of video editor isn't equipped with this feature then your shoot would demand the use of tripods or stabilizing rigs for the camera before bringing it into the edit. Simply put, if you wish to edit a traditional documentary or film then you can safely rely on open source software but if you wish to make a high-end film with a greater degree of stylistic editing choices then you will eventually have to transition to a professional editing suite.

Feature Rich Software

As mentioned earlier, the features of a proprietary software make paying for them well worth the savings in time and effort during your shoot, especially if you're a professional. These features are what separate the professional from the free-user. And while we expect the open source community to soon achieve the finesse of these pro-features over time, they will always remain a step behind due to the nature of the software development industry. So if you feel that your